Chargeback and Fraud Escalation Guidelines

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Purpose

This document sets out how Northlane handles payment disputes, chargebacks and suspected fraudulent activity on customer accounts.

What a chargeback is

A chargeback occurs when a customer disputes a transaction with their card issuer rather than contacting Northlane. The issuer reverses the payment and Northlane is charged a processing fee of 750 rupees per case, whether or not the dispute is later decided in Northlane's favour.

Because the fee is charged either way, preventing a chargeback by resolving the underlying complaint is always cheaper than defending one.

Chargeback response timeline

Northlane has 20 calendar days from notification to submit evidence to the issuer. Evidence is assembled by the finance team and must include the delivery proof, the order record and the full care ticket history.

A case with no delivery proof is not defended and is written off, because the cost of defending it exceeds the amount at stake.

Duplicate and incorrect charges

A duplicate charge is reversed within 3 business days of being confirmed against the payment gateway record. No manager approval is needed to reverse a confirmed duplicate charge, because Northlane is returning money it was never owed.

A charge higher than the checkout total is corrected by refunding the difference within 3 business days.

Indicators that require escalation

The care desk escalates to the fraud team where an account shows any of the following: more than three high value orders to a newly added address within 48 hours, a delivery address that repeatedly changes after despatch, more than two claims of non receipt within 90 days, or a request to refund to an account different from the one that paid.

A refund to an account other than the one that paid is never issued by the care desk. It requires fraud team clearance without exception.

Customer treatment during investigation

A customer under investigation is not told they are under investigation. The care desk states only that the request is being reviewed and gives a date by which the customer will hear back.

An account is not suspended on suspicion alone. Suspension requires fraud team confirmation.